Glossary

Abscission zone	A region near the base of petiole of leaf which contains abscission layer.
Absorption Spectrum	A curve obtained by plotting the amount of absorption of different wavelengths of light by a pigment is called its absorption spectrum.
Acetyl CoA	Small, water-soluble metabolite comprising an acetyl group linked to coenzyme A (CoA).
Action Spectrum	A graphic representation showing the rate of photosynthesis at different wavelengths of light is called action spectrum
Active site	Region of an enzyme molecule where the substrate binds and undergoes a catalyzed reaction.
Aeroponics	A technique of growing plants suspended over the nutrient solution in a mist chamber. Nutrient sprayed by motor driven rotor on the roots.
Agar	Jelly-like substance, derived from red algae
Akinetes	Thick walled, dormant, non motile asexual spores.
Aleurone	Outer layer of the endosperm
Allelopathy	The chemical substances released by one plant species which affect or benefit another plant
Amphicribal/ Hadrocentric	Xylem in the centre with phloem surrounding it. Example: Ferns (Polypodium)
Amphivasal / Leptocentric	Phloem in the centre with xylem surrounding it. Example: Dragon plant – Dracena and Yucca
Anabolic	It is an enzyme catalyzed reaction in a cell that involves synthesis of complex molecules from simple molecules which uses energy.
Anamorph	Asexual or imperfect state of fungi
Anisogamy	Fusion of morphologically and physiologically dissimilar gametes
Apical cell theory	Single apical cell growing into whole plant
Apogamy	Formation of sporophyte from the gametophytic tissue without the fusion of gametes.
Apospory	Development of the gametophyte from the sporophyte without the formation of spores
Axil Parenchyma	Parenchyma arranged longitudinally along the axis
Balausto	Fleshy in dehiscent fruit
Basal body	Structure at the base of cilia and flagella from which microtubules forming the axoneme radiate
Biosphere	The region of earth on which life exist
Buffer	A solution of the acid and base form of a compound that undergoes little change in pH when small quantities of strong acid or base are added.
Callose	Sieve pores are blocked by substances called callose
Carbonic acid	A weak acidic solution of carbon-di-oxide dissolved in water
Carcinogen	Any chemical or physical agent that can cause cancer when cells or organism s are exposed to it.
Catabolic	It is an enzyme catalyzed reaction in a cell that involves degradation of molecules into simple subunits which release energy.
Chelating agents	A chelate is the soluble product formed when certain atoms in an organic ligand donate electrons to the cation.
Chemotaxonomy	Classification based on the biochemical constituents of plants
Chlorosis	Breakdown of chlorophylls leads to yellowing of leaves
Clades	Group of species comprising common ancestor and its descendants
Cladistics	Methodology used to classify organisms into monophyletic group
Closed vascular bundle	Cambium absent between xylem and phloem Example: Monocot stem
Codon	Sequence of three nucleotides in DNA or mRNA that specifies a particular amino acid during protein synthesis; also called triplet
Coenocytic condition	Aseptate, multinucleate condition
Coenzyme	A non-protein molecule involved in enzyme catalyzed reactions serves as transfer of protons or electrons between various molecules
Colloidal	An evenly distributed mixture of two different particles in a system without losing its own properties.
Dalton	Unit of molecular mass approximately equal to the mass of a hydrogen atom ($1.66 \times 10-24$ g)

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